HHH-A-735c
JUNE 16, 1961
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. HHH-A-00735b (AGR-AMS)
June 21, 1960 and
Fed. Spec. HHH-A-735a
May 17, 1951

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

ASPARAGUS, FROZEN

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Types. Frozen asparagus covered by this specification shall be of the following type:

Type I—Green or all-green

1.2 Styles. Frozen asparagus shall be of the following styles as specified (see 6.1):

Style I.—Spears (or stalks).
Style II.—Tips.
Style III.—Cut spears or cuts and tips.
Style IV.—Center cuts or cuts.

1.3 Sizes. Frozen asparagus of style I, spears (or stalks), shall be one or more of the following sizes, as specified (see 6.1):

Size 1 (Small).
Size 2 (Medium).
Size 3 (Large).
Size 4 (Extra large).

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-585—Boxes; Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Military Standard:

MIL–STD–129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following publications, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Governmental:

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement.

(Copies of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and General Regulations for Its Enforcement may be obtained upon application accompanied by money order, coupon, or cash to the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C. Prices may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents.

United States Standards for Grades of Frozen Asparagus.

Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables and Related Products.

(Single copies of the United States Standards for Grades of Frozen Asparagus and applicable regulations may be obtained, without charge, from the U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington 25, D.C.)

Nongovernmental:

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists.

(Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists is published by the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists, P. O. Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington 4, D. C.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Frozen asparagus shall be prepared from fresh asparagus and shall be of the latest pack, unless otherwise specified.

3.2 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

3.3 Determination of grade. Unless otherwise specified, the grade of product shall be determined in accordance with the United States Standards for Grades of Frozen Asparagus (and lot inspection and certification tolerances applicable thereto as set forth in the Regulations Governing Inspection and Certification of Processed Fruits and Vegetables and Related Products) in effect on the date of invitation for bids.

3.4 Fancy (grade A). Frozen asparagus of this grade shall possess similar varietal characteristics; shall be practically free from defects; shall possess a good character; shall possess a good flavor and odor; and, within the limits prescribed in the United States Standards for Grades of Frozen Asparagus, shall possess at least a reasonably good color, and shall be at least reasonably uniform in length.

3.5 Extra standard (grade B). Frozen asparagus of this grade shall possess similar varietal characteristics; shall possess a reasonably good color; shall be reasonably free from defects; shall possess a reasonably good character; shall possess a reasonably good flavor and odor; and, within the limits prescribed in the United States Standards for Grades of Frozen Asparagus, may vary in uniformity of length.

3.6 Sanitation and workmanship. Frozen asparagus shall be prepared, processed, and packed under sanitary conditions and in accordance with good commercial practice. Catalase shall be inactivated. The product shall be frozen and maintained at temperatures necessary for the preservation of the product. Containers shall be clean and well-sealed.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.7 Condition at time of delivery. Frozen asparagus shall be in a frozen state at time of delivery, shall not show any evidence of refreezing, and otherwise shall be in good condition.

3.7.1 *Military agencies.* In addition to the requirements of 3.7, the unit packages shall have a maximum uniform temperature of 0°F. or less.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling. Samples of finished products covered by this specification and samples of any materials, components, or constituents entering into the preparation of the finished products may be taken at any time by the Government inspector to determine compliance with the requirements.

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 *General.* Inspection shall be made by the procuring agency or a duly authorized representative at the time and place designated by the procuring agency. It may be made at the site of manufacture, both during and after processing, at any suitable point in transit, and/or after delivery to the point of destination.

4.2.2 *Factory inspection.* The passing as satisfactory of any detail of processing or materials shall not relieve the contractor of responsibility for faulty workmanship or materials which may be discovered at any time prior to final acceptance.

4.2.3 *Final inspection.* Unless otherwise specified, final inspection shall be made after delivery to the point of destination (see 6.3 and 6.4).

4.2.4 *USDA certificate of quality and condition.* When specified by the procuring agency the contractor shall furnish a U. S. Department of Agriculture Certificate of Quality and Condition as outlined in procurement documents.

4.3 Tests.

4.3.1 *Chemical analyses.* Unless otherwise specified, chemical analyses, if required by the purchaser, shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Agricultural Chemists in effect on the date of the invitation for bids or in accordance with methods that give equivalent results.

4.4 For military agencies. The supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

For civil agency procurement the definitions and applications of the levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Federal Standard No. 102.

5.1 Packaging. The product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1 or 5.1.2, as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 *Level A.* The product shall be packaged in accordance with 5.1.1.1 or 5.1.1.2, as specified (see 6.1). Individual packages, other than bulk packaging, within a shipping container shall not exceed 5 pounds net weight. Bulk packaging of the product directly into shipping containers other than metal will not be acceptable.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.1.1 *Cans.* The product shall be packaged in all metal cans or in cans with fiberboard bodies and metal ends, the size, style, and net contents of which shall be the same as that normally used by the packer.

5.1.1.2 *Cartons.* The product shall be packaged in cartons, the size, style and net contents of which shall be the same as that normally used by the packer. The cartons shall be overwrapped and completely heat sealed in one of the materials specified below. Alternatively, the product may be enclosed in a heat-sealable bag made from one of the materials specified below and the sealed bag enclosed in a carton. If a bag is used, the carton need not be overwrapped. Any of the following materials may be used as the overwrapping or bag materials: Cellophane, waxed paper, polyethylene, or rubber hydrochloride-base-plastic film of good quality commercial materials normally used in packing frozen foods.

5.1.2 *Level C.* The product shall be packaged in the unit quantity specified in the contract or order, in accordance with the contractor's normal practice for such commodity.

5.2 **Packing.** The product shall be packed in accordance with 5.2.1, 5.2.2, or 5.2.3, as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 *Level A.*

5.2.1.1 *Fiberboard box, V3s or V3c.* Not more than 40 pounds of the product net weight, packaged as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box, constructed and sealed in accordance with type I or II, class 2, grade 3 of Federal Specification PPP–B–636. The box shall be strapped in accordance with the Appendix to Federal Specification PPP–B–636 except that 3 straps shall be used. Two straps shall be applied lengthwise over the top, ends and bottom and the third strap shall be applied girthwise centered over the top, sides, and bottom. The longer straps shall be applied first.

5.2.1.2 *Wirebound wood box.* Alternatively, two fiberboard shipping containers, each containing not more than 30 pounds net weight of the product, packaged as specified in 5.1.1 and packed and sealed as specified in 5.2.2, may be packed in a snug-fitting wirebound wood box, constructed in accordance with style 2, 2A, or 3, type 2 load, class 3 use, of Federal Specification PPP–B–585.

5.2.1.3 *Nailed wood box.* Alternatively, two fiberboard shipping containers, each containing not more than 30 pounds net weight of the product, packaged as specified in 5.1.1, and packed and sealed as specified in 5.2.2, may be packed in a snug-fitting nailed wood box constructed in accordance with style 4, class 2, of Federal Specification PPP–B–621.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Not more than 40 pounds of the product, net weight basis, packaged as specified in 5.1.2, shall be packed in a snug-fitting corrugated or solid fiberboard, nailed wood, or wirebound wood box, constructed in accordance with type I or II, class 1, of Federal Specification PPP–B–636; style 4, class 1, for type 2 load of Federal Specification PPP–B–621; or style 2, 2A, or 3, type 2 load of Federal Specification PPP–B–585, respectively. If fiberboard boxes are used, they shall be made from board having a minimum bursting strength of 200 pounds per square inch. The flaps of the fiberboard container shall be securely sealed with an adhesive commonly used for the specific product being packed, applied throughout the entire area of contact between the flaps, or by a combination of stitching one set of flaps prior to packing and sealing the other flaps with the adhesive. When flaps are stitched, the stitches shall be distributed so as to fasten all flaps securely together over the entire area of contact between the inner and outer flaps and to prevent lifting of free edges and

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

corners of the outer flaps. No additional shipping container is necessary when 25 pounds or more of the product are packed in a metal container.

5.2.3 *Level C.* The commodity shall be packed in a manner acceptable to common carrier for safe transportation to point of destination specified in shipping instructions at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.*

5.3.1.1 *Unit containers.* Any commercial labeling, and additional labeling as specified, that complies with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, and regulations promulgated thereunder, is acceptable.

5.3.1.2 *Cooking instructions.* Unless otherwise specified, each carton or package shall include cooking instructions on the carton or package, on the outer wrapper, or on an attached label, except that cooking instructions for bulk sizes (11 pounds or more) may be printed on a paper sheet placed on top of the container or containers within each shipping container.

5.3.1.3 *Shipping containers.* Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with the requirements of Federal Standard No. 123, and such other information as specified by individual agencies.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.*

5.3.2.1 *Unit containers.* Unless otherwise specified, labeling as specified in 5.3.1.1 and 5.3.1.2 is acceptable.

5.3.2.2 *Shipping containers.* Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129 and as specified in 5.3.2.2.1.

5.3.2.2.1 *Additional markings.* In addition to the markings specified in 5.3.2.2, the following precautionary markings shall appear on the top and on the side opposite the marked side of the container, in letters between 1 and 1½ inches high, all letters being of the same height.

KEEP FROZEN
(0° F. or below)

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) The style, size or sizes, and grade of product desired (see 1.2 and 1.3).
(*b*) Size and kind of packaging required.
(*c*) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(*d*) Type of container (cans or cartons) required for level A packaging (see 5.1.1).

6.2 If samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated.

6.3 Contractor's inspection. The contractor should be required to assure that the product conforms with the specification prior to submission to the Government for final inspection.

6.4 Destination inspection. When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

6.5 Transportation description. Transportation description and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Rail:

Vegetables, frozen, fresh or green, sweetened or not sweetened.
Carload minimum weight 36,000 pounds.

Motor:

Vegetables, fresh or green, frozen, sweetened or not sweetened.
Motor volume minimum weight 36,000 pounds.

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded, by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Army—Q M
Navy—S MC
Air Force—MAAMA.

☆ U. S. GOVERNMENT PRINTING OFFICE: 1961

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:44Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.